

ZOKA Litepaper

Privacy by default. In plain language.

This is the short version of the ZOKA project, written for people who do not want to read a formal cryptography paper before deciding whether to install a wallet.

If you want the full technical document, with the math and the protocol layout, read the **Whitepaper** instead.

What is ZOKA?

ZOKA is an internet-wide payment network where every payment is private by default. Nobody on the network — not a stranger looking at the blockchain, not a competitor, not a regulator, not even the engineers who built the protocol — can see who sent money to whom, or how much.

It is open, anyone can join, and the code is public on GitHub. It uses standard cryptography that has been studied for years (zero-knowledge proofs, ring signatures, stealth addresses). It is not magic, and it is not a marketing trick. It is the same kind of cryptography that keeps your messages private in apps like Signal, applied to payments instead of texts.

Why does this matter?

In most blockchains, every transaction is publicly visible forever. Your salary, your rent, your donations, the coffee you bought this morning — recorded in a database that anyone with a browser can read for the rest of time. Companies already use this data to profile users. Governments are starting to use it to deny services. Criminals use it to target people who own crypto.

A traditional bank does not work that way. Your transactions are private from the public. You trust the bank not to abuse the data. ZOKA gives you the same privacy as a bank, without having to trust anyone — because the protocol mathematically refuses to publish the data in the first place.

Privacy is not a feature. It is the precondition of freedom.

How does it work? (Without the math)

Imagine a payment system with three problems:

1. **Hiding who sent the money.** ZOKA hides each sender inside a small crowd of plausible senders. The network cannot tell which one really paid; it only confirms one of them did.
2. **Hiding who received the money.** Each payment is sent to a one-time address that nobody reuses. The recipient's "real" address never appears on the chain. Only the recipient can recognize their own payments.
3. **Hiding the amount.** The amount of each payment is encrypted. The network can still verify that no money was created out of thin air — using a kind of math called zero-knowledge proofs — without ever seeing the number itself.

When all three are combined, an outside observer sees: "something happened, between someone and someone, for some amount". That is all they can see. The math forbids more.

What is different from Bitcoin, Ethereum, Monero, Zcash?

Network	Privacy by default?	Hides amount?	ASIC-resistant?
Bitcoin	No	No	No
Ethereum	No	No	Not applicable
Monero	Yes	Yes	Yes
Zcash	Optional	Optional	No
ZOKA	Yes	Yes	Yes

ZOKA takes the parts of Monero (privacy is mandatory, not optional) and Zcash (zero-knowledge proofs) that work best in practice, and puts them together with a CPU-friendly mining design so that anyone with a normal laptop can participate.

The token — ZKA

ZOKA's native token is called **ZKA**. The numbers in plain words:

- There will ever be only **23 million ZKA**, like Bitcoin's 21 million cap. No more can be created after that.

- **There is no premine.** No tokens were given to the developer, an investor, or a foundation. The only way ZKA exists is by mining new blocks.
- Mining new blocks gives **12 ZKA** at first, and the reward halves roughly every four years, the same emission shape as Bitcoin.
- A new block is mined every **2 minutes** on average.
- Newly mined coins are usable after **60 blocks** of maturity (~2 hours).

If you mine, your reward is itself private. Even the size of your earnings is not visible to anyone. ZKA is denominated to six decimal places: 1 ZKA = 1,000,000 atoms.

How can you participate?

You can use ZOKA in three ways, from easiest to most involved.

1. Install the desktop wallet (easiest)

Download **ZSilent Core** for Windows or Linux from the official release page:

github.com/ZokaNetwork/zsilent-core/releases/latest

It includes the node, the wallet, and a one-click mining toggle. No installation of Rust, no terminal, no configuration. Open it, set a password, and you have a private wallet.

2. Run a node from the terminal (intermediate)

If you have a server or just prefer the command line, build and run the open-source node:

```
git clone https://github.com/ZokaNetwork/ZokaNetwork.git cd ZokaNetwork cargo
build --release --features randomx --bin zoka --bin zokahd
./target/release/zoka fullnode --network mainnet
```

The README in the repo has the full guide.

3. Build from source and contribute (advanced)

The full network is in Rust. Privacy-focused work, anonymous transport on Tor/I2P, mobile clients, and post-quantum migration are all on the roadmap. Pull requests are welcome.

What ZOKA can do, and what it can't

Can

- Send and receive value without revealing sender, recipient or amount on the chain.
- Mine new ZKA from any CPU; no specialized hardware required.
- Verify every transaction yourself by running your own node.
- Operate without giving an email, phone number or any KYC document to anyone.

Cannot

- Recover funds if you lose your wallet seed phrase. There is no support team and no password reset. You own your money completely, with the responsibility that comes with it.
- Protect you from a global passive adversary watching every internet cable in real time.
- Resist a future quantum computer attack against today's cryptography. Past transactions remain hidden; new ones after a quantum break would not.
- Hide that a transaction occurred. The fact that someone, somewhere, did something on the chain is necessarily public — only the details are hidden.
- Reverse a payment. Sending to the wrong address has no undo.

This list is short and honest by design. Anyone who promises perfect privacy in a payment system is selling something.

Status today (v0.1.0)

- Mainnet is **live** with a public bootstrap node.
- The desktop wallet (ZSilent Core) is **released** for Windows and Linux.
- The block explorer is **online**.
- Tor / I2P anonymous transport is **planned**, not yet running by default.
- An external cryptographic audit is **planned**, not yet completed.
- macOS and mobile wallets are **planned** for later releases.

This is a real, working, public network you can join today, and a project that still has work ahead of it. Both things are true at the same time, and we are not going to pretend otherwise.

Where to learn more

- **Whitepaper** (technical, 12 pages): [/ZOKA_Whitepaper_v1.0.pdf](#)
- **Code on GitHub**: github.com/ZokaNetwork
- **Block explorer**: see the home page of zoka.network for the live link
- **Desktop wallet downloads**: github.com/ZokaNetwork/zsilent-core/releases

Verify what is true. Reveal nothing else.

— Natosh Zoka, core dev @ ZokaNetwork